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CART 315 Digital Game Prototype

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Reading Reflection 2

What stood out from the reading is Schön's idea that there's "no direct path" between a designer's intention and the final outcome. I found this to be relatable because when working on my own projects, I often start with a specific idea that later turns into something completely different at the end of it. Instead of seeing unexpected results as a failure, the chapter made me think about them as part of the design process.

I especially connected with the idea of "backtalk." Schön describes moments when the material or system responds in a way that makes the designer think, "this isn't what I intended or expected but maybe there is something interesting happening here." This reminds me of experimenting with interactive media, where unexpected interaction can lead to a better or interesting direction than the original plan.

The Growltiger example from the reading stood out to me because we as students learn through experimenting, seeing surprising results, and changing their understanding based on those results. It fits in very well with playtesting and design iteration. In some cases, the designer cannot know what their creation is all about until someone else engages with it. In any case, the readings have made me realize that design is less about constructing a concept than engaging in conversation with the concept and its users.